

ONE MORE DAY

Genre: Drama / Inspirational

Duration: Maximum 5 Minutes

Primary Conflict: Man vs. Himself

Theme: Everyone has their own timeline. Success is not a race against others.

Main Character: DEV, 21 — a college student who initially takes life casually but later struggles with pressure, failure, self-doubt, and finally finds his own path.

The story follows the **Man vs. Himself** conflict, where the protagonist's greatest struggle is with his own fear, comparison, frustration, and self-doubt. The screenplay builds toward an unavoidable breaking point before resolving with his transformation. This follows the narrative framework given in the provided scriptwriting material.

SCENE 1 — HOSTEL ROOM — MORNING

TIME: 0:00-0:35

FADE IN:

Sunlight enters through a half-open hostel window.

A phone alarm rings.

CLOSE UP — PHONE

8:30 AM

DEV's hand comes from under the blanket and stops the alarm.

He looks at the time.

Smiles.

Turns around and goes back to sleep.

CUT TO:

Dev and his friends sitting on the hostel balcony, laughing.

Someone plays music from a phone.

They eat snacks, joke around and enjoy themselves.

FRIEND 1

Bro, today also no class?

DEV

Relax da. One day isn't going to change my life.

Everyone laughs.

MONTAGE:

- Dev playing games.
- Friends watching movies.
- Late-night conversations.
- Dev scrolling through his phone.
- An assignment notification appears.
- Dev ignores it.

CLOSE UP — DEV

Carefree and relaxed.

CUT TO BLACK.

SCENE 2 — HOSTEL CORRIDOR — EVENING

TIME: 0:35-1:15

The atmosphere has changed.

Students gather around a phone.

Someone suddenly screams.

FRIEND 2

Bro! I got placed!

Everyone cheers.

Dev smiles and hugs him.

DEV

Semma da! Congrats!

Another friend enters.

FRIEND 3

Guys... I got selected too!

More celebration.

Dev continues smiling.

But slowly, his smile fades.

CLOSE UP — PHONE SCREEN

A placement announcement.

Names of selected students.

Dev scrolls.

His name isn't there.

CUT TO:**THE NEXT DAY.**

Another friend receives an offer.

Then another.

MONTAGE — TIME PASSING

- Placement posters on the college notice board.
- Friends taking photographs in formal clothes.
- LinkedIn placement posts.
- Friends packing their hostel bags.
- Dev watching them leave.
- Empty beds appearing in the hostel.

One friend stops before leaving.

FRIEND 1

You'll be next, bro.

Dev forces a smile.

DEV

Yeah... definitely.

The friend leaves.

Dev stands alone in the corridor.

SCENE 3 — THE GRIND — NIGHT

TIME: 1:15-2:10

MUSIC BEGINS.

A slow, repetitive beat.

Dev sits alone at his desk.

Laptop open.

ON SCREEN:

Data Structures — Practice

He starts solving a problem.

SCREEN:

WRONG ANSWER

Dev tries again.

SCREEN:

WRONG ANSWER

He rubs his eyes.

Drinks coffee.

Continues.

MONTAGE:

- **2:13 AM** on the clock.
- Dev solving coding problems.
- Notes covering the table.
- Dev watching interview preparation videos.

- Mock interview.
- Dev practicing in front of a mirror.

INTERVIEWER (V.O.)

Tell me about yourself.

Dev hesitates.

DEV

I... I'm...

CUT.

He stops the recording.

NEXT DAY.

The same routine.

He wakes up.

Studies.

Attends class.

Returns.

Studies again.

TIME PASSES.

A calendar fills with crossed-out dates.

PHONE SCREEN:

"Unfortunately, we have decided to move forward with other candidates."

Dev stares at the message.

He locks his phone.

Continues studying.

Another rejection.

Another application.

Another rejection.

NIGHT.

Dev sits alone in the hostel room.

The room is silent.

He looks at photographs of his friends who have already left.

He looks at himself in the mirror.

Exhausted.

SCENE 4 — THE BREAKING POINT

TIME: 2:10-2:45

Rain hits the hostel window.

Dev sits at his desk.

His laptop shows another rejection email.

He closes it.

Opens another application.

Then another.

His hands begin shaking.

He throws the pen onto the table.

DEV

Enough!

Silence.

He stands.

DEV

How much more?

He looks around the empty room.

DEV

Everyone moved ahead...

His voice breaks.

DEV

What am I doing wrong?

He pushes the chair back.

The chair falls.

Dev breathes heavily.

He looks at himself in the mirror.

CLOSE UP — MIRROR

A tired Dev stares back.

DEV

Maybe I'm not good enough.

Silence.

He looks down.

Then slowly looks back into the mirror.

DEV

...or maybe I just haven't finished yet.

He picks up the fallen chair.

Sits down.

Opens the laptop again.

CUT TO BLACK.

SCENE 5 — ONE MORE DAY

TIME: 2:45–3:35

MUSIC CHANGES.

The beat becomes stronger.

MONTAGE:

5:00 AM

Alarm rings.

Dev gets up immediately.

He washes his face.

Runs outside.

Returns.

Studies.

Solves problems.

Fails.

Tries again.

Practices interviews.

Records himself speaking.

DEV

My name is Dev, and I...

He stops.

Takes a breath.

Starts again.

DEV

My name is Dev...

MORE MONTAGE:

- Code runs successfully.
- Dev smiles.
- Mock interview.
- He answers confidently.
- Another job application.
- Another interview.
- Dev walking into an interview room.
- Dev walking out.

PHONE RINGS.

Dev looks at the screen.

UNKNOWN NUMBER

He answers.

DEV

Hello?

Silence.

His expression slowly changes.

VOICE (V.O.)

Congratulations, Dev.

Dev doesn't respond.

He closes his eyes.

A small smile appears.

VOICE (V.O.)

We'd like to offer you the position.

Dev exhales.

He looks around the same hostel room.

The same room where he had broken down.

But now, he smiles.

SCENE 6 — YEARS LATER

TIME: 3:35–4:10

MATCH CUT:

Young Dev closes his laptop.

CUT TO:

An older, confident Dev closes a laptop in a modern office.

TEXT ON SCREEN:

"5 YEARS LATER"

Dev walks out of the office.

Gets into his car.

Drives away.

CUT TO:

The car stops near a quiet natural location.

Dev gets out.

He takes a deep breath.

No phone.

No laptop.

No notifications.

Just silence.

He begins walking.

SCENE 7 — PEACE

TIME: 4:10-4:45

Dev walks through nature.

He stretches.

Runs slowly.

Stops beside a tree.

Looks at the sky.

The sound of birds replaces the sound of notifications and keyboards.

He sits down.

Closes his eyes.

Takes a deep breath.

CLOSE UP — DEV

Peaceful.

His phone vibrates inside his pocket.

He takes it out.

Looks at it.

For a moment, he considers answering.

Then he switches it to silent.

Puts it back into his pocket.

Smiles.

VOICEOVER — DEV

I used to think success meant reaching everyone before they reached me.

PAUSE.

He looks around at the surroundings.

DEV (V.O.)

I spent years trying to catch up.

PAUSE.

DEV (V.O.)

Then I realized...

Dev looks toward the distance.

DEV (V.O.)

I was never running against them.

CLOSE UP.

DEV (V.O.)

I was running against myself.

SCENE 8 — ENDING

TIME: 4:45-5:00

Dev slowly stands up.

He starts walking away from the camera.

Sunlight shines through the trees.

DEV (V.O.)

Some people reach their destination early.

PAUSE.

DEV (V.O.)

Some take a little longer.

PAUSE.

DEV (V.O.)

That doesn't mean they're lost.

Dev continues walking.

DEV (V.O.)

Sometimes...

He keeps walking.

DEV (V.O.)

all you need...

PAUSE.

DEV (V.O.)

is one more day.

CUT TO BLACK.

ONE MORE DAY

"Your timeline is not a measure of your worth."

FADE OUT.

THE END